

CHATHURA SENEVIRATHNE

Chemical & Process Engineer | Manufacturing Excellence | Reliability Engineering

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[Linkedin|chathura-senevirathne](#) | Open Work Visa Holder

PROFILE

Experienced engineering professional with 5+ years at Unilever across utilities, manufacturing operations, and plant engineering. Expertise in maintenance and reliability engineering, root cause analysis, utilities management, CAPEX delivery, automation, safety leadership, and continuous improvement. Proven success in reducing engineering losses, optimizing manpower through automation, developing high-performing teams, and delivering operational excellence in a multinational FMCG environment. Valid New Zealand work visa holder with immediate availability.

KEY SKILLS

- Manufacturing Engineering
- Reliability Engineering
- Mechanical & Process Engineering
- Project Engineering & Commissioning
- Automation & Line Transformation
- Preventive & Predictive Maintenance
- Root Cause Analysis (RCA)
- Continuous Improvement & Lean Manufacturing
- Asset Management & Equipment Reliability
- Utilities Management (Boilers, Chillers, Water & Wastewater Treatment, Compressors)
- Safety, Health & Environment (SHE)

PROJECTS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Rainwater Harvesting & Treatment Plant Implementation** (Supply Chain Hero Award 2022) - Designed and commissioned a rainwater harvesting and treatment system (UF, pH adjustment, chlorination), enabling 25% of factory water demand to be met through harvested rainwater.
- **Rexona Soap Relaunch – Line Transformation & Automation** - Led a phased packing line automation project that increased capacity to 90 units/min and reduced manpower requirements by 71% (14 to 4 operators per shift).
- **Engineering Loss Reduction Project** - Reduced engineering-related manufacturing losses from 5.0% to 3.2% through reliability improvements, RCA-driven interventions, and strengthened PM/BM governance.
- **Fuel Crisis Business Continuity Project** (Supply Chain Hero Team Award 2022) - Maintained zero fuel-related production stoppages during Sri Lanka's fuel crisis by increasing diesel storage capacity by 50% and implementing predictive fuel planning.
- **Packaging Machine Overhaul & Spare Parts Localization** - Led major overhauls of ACMA 325 and ACMA 741 packaging machines, reducing spare part costs from LKR 18 Mn to LKR 2 Mn through localization and extending equipment life by approximately five years.

WORK HISTORY

Unilever Sri Lanka Limited (Horana, Sri Lanka) | Apr 2021 – Present | <https://www.unilever.com.lk/>

Assistant Plant Engineer – Soap Plant | Aug 2024 – Present

- Reduced mechanical changeover losses by 10% through equipment optimization, improved settings, and standardized mechanical practices.
- Delivered a 22% improvement in equipment reliability by leading root cause failure analysis and targeted corrective actions.
- Controlled maintenance expenditure by managing budgets, planned overhauls, and critical spare parts, achieving LKR 6 Mn cost savings in repair spend.
- Planned and executed preventive maintenance schedules and predictive maintenance to improve asset availability and reduce unplanned downtime.
- Optimized production asset deployment through line consolidation and cascade rationalization, improving AU/CU, reducing energy consumption, and releasing capacity for new product innovations.
- Repurposed and modified an idle case packer to automate bundle packing operations, improving safety, consistency, and 33% labor reduction.

Shift Manager – Soap Plant | Jan 2024 – Aug 2024

- Delivered daily production plans, maintaining ~80% OEE through effective shift control and productivity improvement and lead the Safety, Health, & Environment (SHE) Pillar.
- Ensured compliance with safety, quality, GMP, and hygiene standards across soap manufacturing and packing operations.
- Achieved a significant reduction in product changeover time on the SLO1 line from 2.5hrs to 1.5hrs, improving line availability and operational efficiency.
- Developed operator capability through on-the-job coaching, improving team competence and ownership of equipment performance.

Shift Engineer – Utility & Premises Department | Apr 2021 – Dec 2023

- Managed environmental reporting and utility KPIs for energy, water, and fuel.
- Increased rainwater harvesting from 14,000 to 25,000 tons and introduced rainwater for process use.
- Improved potable water quality, compressed air efficiency, and chiller plant reliability.
- Restored a critical -20°C ammonia refrigeration system following a major breakdown, improving reliability and redundancy with zero impact on manufacturing operations.
- Implemented a controlled-environment greenhouse project, achieving crop yields exceeding 1000kg and enhancing sustainability initiatives.
- Achieved a 50% reduction in RO treatment chemical usage by optimizing dosing strategies and improving system efficiency.
- Planned and executed the mandatory 5-year boiler NDT inspection program, ensuring statutory compliance, defect rectification, and continued safe operation.

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Science in Engineering (Hons) – Chemical & Process Engineering – Second Upper Division (Washington Accord Accredited)
University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka | 2015 – 2020

Referees available on request